

PURPOSE

Krona is a flexible tool for exploring the relative proportions of hierarchical data, such as metagenomic classifications, using a radial, space-filling display. It is implemented using HTML5 and JavaScript, allowing charts to be explored locally or served over the Internet, requiring only a current version of any major web browser. Krona charts can be created using an Excel template or from common bioinformatic formats using the provided conversion scripts.

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PATENTS

The Krona software is not eligible for patent because there have been previous and open implementations of this visualization method since the year 2000 (e.g. "Focus+context display and navigation techniques for enhancing radial, space-filling hierarchy visualizations." Stasko, J. and Zhang, E. InfoVis, 2000). Krona represents a reimplementaion and application of an existing method to the new domain of metagenomics. BNBI, as the copyright holders, wish to release Krona freely and openly as a service to the bioinformatics community.

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